

THE SOCIETY OF ST. VINCENT DE PAUL

Neighbors helping Neighbors

Voucher System

How-To Guide for Administrators & Managers

What You Need to Know

This guide is for people who manage the Voucher System configuration and approve special cashier actions. It explains the admin tabs, the catalog tools, manager codes, reason lists, audit review, and cashier-station actions that need manager approval or careful supervisor review.

- Most admin work happens in WordPress under the SVdP Vouchers admin page.
- Most manager-code work happens in the Cashier Station when the system asks for approval.
- Changes to catalogs and settings affect future requests. Existing voucher snapshots keep their historical information.

Important: Manager codes should be treated like keys. Give them only to people who are allowed to approve exceptions or voucher corrections.

Opening the Admin Area

Step 1: Sign in to WordPress with an account that has permission to manage the Voucher System.

Step 2: Open the WordPress Dashboard.

Step 3: Go to the SVdP Vouchers admin page.

Step 4: Use the tabs across the top to choose the area you need.

Admin Tabs at a Glance

TAB	WHAT IT IS FOR
Analytics	Reporting, voucher activity, exports, and operational review.
Conferences	Conference and Partner organization records, access, and request form details.
Furniture Catalog	Furniture categories and furniture catalog items.
Furniture Reasons	Preset cancellation reasons used when furniture items cannot be fulfilled.
Household Goods	Browse groups, Household Goods categories, request limits, and configuration audit.
Invoices / Statements / Accounting	Billing and accounting review for fulfilled furniture and household goods work.
Managers	Manager names, active status, and manager codes.
Override Reasons	Reasons shown when manager approval is required.
Voucher Correction Audit	Read-only history of manager-authorized voucher corrections.
Settings	Item values, voucher types, delivery options, form text, database counts, and system information.

Managing the Furniture Catalog

The Furniture Catalog controls what Conferences and Partners can request and what the store team sees during furniture fulfillment.

Furniture Categories

Step 1: Open the Furniture Catalog tab.

Step 2: In Furniture Categories, enter the category name.

Step 3: Enter a sort order if you want the category to appear in a specific order.

Step 4: Click Add Category.

- Use Edit to change a category name or sort order.
- Use Archive to hide a category from future use.
- A category cannot be archived while active items remain in it.

Furniture Catalog Items

Step 1: Open the Furniture Catalog tab.

Step 2: In Furniture Catalog, enter the item name.

Step 3: Choose the category.

Step 4: Choose the pricing type: Range or Fixed.

Step 5: Enter the price fields shown for that pricing type.

Step 6: Choose whether public range pricing should show as Up to the maximum amount.

Step 7: Choose the Conference Coverage Type: Percent or Fixed Dollar Amount.

Step 8: Enter the coverage value and sort order.

Step 9: Click Add Catalog Item.

- Use range pricing for used furniture or items where final price can vary.
- Use fixed pricing for handmade furniture, mattresses, frames, or items with one set price.
- Furniture catalog items can be archived, but they are not deleted from the system.
- This protects old voucher records. If a neighbor requested a Sofa six months ago, that old voucher still needs to show Sofa even if Sofa is no longer offered for new requests.
- Use Archive when an item should disappear from future request forms. Use Restore if it should be offered again.

Furniture Cancellation Reasons

Furniture Cancellation Reasons are the preset choices used when a requested furniture item cannot be provided.

Step 1: Open the Furniture Reasons tab.

Step 2: Enter the Reason Text.

Step 3: Enter a Display Order if you want to control where it appears.

Step 4: Click Add Cancellation Reason.

- Use Edit to change the reason text or display order.
- Use Archive when a reason should no longer be used.
- Archive old reasons instead of deleting them so past furniture records stay readable.
- This keeps old records clear because the reason selected at the time can still be understood later.

Managing the Household Goods Catalog

Household Goods uses browse groups and requestable categories. Browse groups control the filter pills. Categories are the actual household goods needs that can be requested.

Browse Groups

Step 1: Open the Household Goods tab.

Step 2: In Household Goods Browse Groups, enter the group name.

Step 3: Enter a sort order.

Step 4: Click Add Browse Group.

- Use Edit to change the name or sort order.
- Use Archive to hide a browse group from future requests.
- Browse groups can be archived when they should no longer appear for new requests.
- They are kept in the system so old Household Goods requests can still be read accurately later.

Household Goods Categories

Step 1: Open the Household Goods tab.

Step 2: In Household Goods Catalog, enter the category name.

Step 3: Choose the browse group.

Step 4: Choose pricing type: Fixed or Range.

Step 5: Enter the retail price fields shown for that pricing type.

Step 6: Choose whether public range pricing should show as Up to the maximum amount.

Step 7: Choose Organization Coverage Type: Percent or Fixed Dollar Amount.

Step 8: Enter Organization Coverage, Quantity Maximum, Sort Order, and Cashier Guidance if needed.

Step 9: Click Add Household Goods Category.

- Quantity Maximum limits how many of that category can be requested. Use 0 for no category-level limit.
- Cashier Guidance is for managed staff guidance only. It is not shown to Vincentians.
- Household Goods categories can be archived, but they are not deleted from the system.
- This protects old voucher records. If a neighbor requested Bath Towels before the category was archived, that old voucher still needs to show Bath Towels.
- Use Archive when a category should disappear from future request forms. Use Restore if it should be offered again.

Household Goods Limits

Step 1: Open the Household Goods tab.

Step 2: Find Household Goods Limits.

Step 3: Set Maximum Selected Categories.

Step 4: Set Maximum Total Requested Quantity.

Step 5: Use 0 when no limit should apply.

Step 6: Click Save Limits.

Configuration Audit

- The Household Goods Configuration Audit is read-only.
- It shows what changed, who changed it, before and after values, and a summary.

Managing Managers and Codes

Managers approve emergency voucher overrides and voucher corrections. Each active manager has one unique 4-character code.

Add a New Manager

- Step 1:** Open the Managers tab.
- Step 2:** Enter the Manager Name.
- Step 3:** Optional: enter a 4-character code using A-Z and 2-9.
- Step 4:** If you leave the code blank, the system generates one.
- Step 5:** Click Add Manager.
- Step 6:** When the code appears, save it securely right away.

Important: The code is shown only when the manager is created or when the code is regenerated.

Regenerate a Manager Code

- Step 1:** Open the Managers tab.
- Step 2:** Find the active manager.
- Step 3:** Click Regenerate Code.
- Step 4:** Confirm that you want to generate a new code.
- Step 5:** Save the new code securely.
 - The old code stops working immediately.
 - Regenerating a code also clears failed attempts and lockout for that manager.

Deactivate a Manager

- Step 1:** Open the Managers tab.
- Step 2:** Find the active manager.
- Step 3:** Click Deactivate.
- Step 4:** Confirm the deactivation.
 - A deactivated manager code no longer works.
 - Use this when someone should no longer approve exceptions.

Override Reasons

Override Reasons appear in the dropdown when manager approval is required for an emergency voucher override or voucher correction.

- Step 1:** Open the Override Reasons tab.
- Step 2:** To add a reason, enter Reason Text and click Add Reason.
- Step 3:** To edit a reason, click Edit, update the text, and click Save.
- Step 4:** To remove a reason from the list, click Delete.
- Step 5:** To reorder reasons, drag the rows into the order you want.
 - Use simple reasons that explain the decision clearly.

- The selected reason is saved with the approval attempt or correction record.

Voucher Correction Audit

The Voucher Correction Audit is a read-only history of manager-authorized voucher corrections.

How to Filter the Audit

Step 1: Open the Voucher Correction Audit tab.

Step 2: Use any filter you need: Voucher ID, Neighbor, Field, Manager, Actor, Reason, Date From, Date To, or Per Page.

Step 3: Click Filter.

Step 4: Use Clear Filters to return to the full list.

How to Read an Audit Row

FIELD	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
Summary	Plain-language description of what changed.
Voucher	The voucher number and neighbor connected to the change.
Field	Which voucher field changed.
Manager	The manager name recorded with the approval.
Actor	The logged-in user who submitted the change.
Reason	The selected reason at the time of approval.
Conference	The Conference or Partner tied to the voucher.
Timestamp	When the correction was recorded.

Settings Page

The Settings tab controls system-wide text and values. Be careful here: settings can change what users see and how redemption values are calculated.

SECTION	WHAT IT CONTROLS
Item Value Configuration	Adult Item Value and Child Item Value used when clothing vouchers are redeemed.
Example Calculation	Shows how adult and child item values calculate an estimated redemption total.
Voucher Types Management	Available root voucher types, delivery availability, and Assistance Needed descriptions.
Available Voucher Types	Comma-separated root types. Current supported types are clothing, furniture, and household_goods.
Delivery Available	Whether delivery can be selected for each voucher type.
Assistance Step Description	The short description shown on the public request form for each voucher type.
Form Boilerplate Text	Store Hours and Redemption Instructions shown on request forms.
Database Info	Current voucher and active Conference counts.
System Information	Plugin version, WordPress version, and PHP version.

Step 1: Open the Settings tab.

Step 2: Make the needed changes.

Step 3: Click Save All Settings.

Step 4: Wait for the settings saved message.

Use care: Changing voucher types, delivery settings, or request-form language can affect future Conference and Partner requests.

Manager Approval in the Cashier Station

Manager codes are used in the Cashier Station when the system asks for approval. The manager enters their name, 4-character code, and a reason.

Override an Emergency Voucher Duplicate

Step 1: A cashier fills out an Emergency Voucher.

Step 2: If an exact duplicate is found, the system opens Duplicate Found: Manager Approval Required.

Step 3: Review the neighbor, issuing organization, created date, and next eligible date.

Step 4: Enter the manager code.

Step 5: Enter the manager name exactly as it appears in the Managers list.

Step 6: Choose the reason.

Step 7: Click Validate & Create.

- If approved, the emergency clothing voucher is created.
- If cancelled, the duplicate denial can be saved for tracking.

Edit a Voucher

Voucher correction is used when voucher details need to be changed after creation. It requires manager approval and creates an audit row.

Step 1: In the Cashier Station, search for and open the voucher.

Step 2: Open the Correct Voucher section.

Step 3: Update only the fields that need correction.

Step 4: Choose the correction reason.

Step 5: Enter the manager name.

Step 6: Enter the manager code.

Step 7: Click Submit Correction.

Step 8: Confirm the success message and review the voucher details.

- Editable fields can include household counts, date of birth, voucher created date, status, and delivery address fields when present.
- The audit records the manager, actor, reason, field changed, before value, after value, and timestamp.

Cancel a Furniture Item

Furniture item cancellation uses the Furniture Cancellation Reasons list. In ordinary flow, the manager code is not entered on the cancellation form, but this should still be handled with supervisor judgment.

Step 1: Open the furniture voucher in the Cashier Station.

Step 2: Find the requested furniture item.

Step 3: Click Cancel Item.

Step 4: Choose the Cancellation Reason.

Step 5: Add notes if helpful.

Step 6: Click Confirm Cancellation.

- Use cancellation only when the item cannot be provided.

- The selected cancellation reason comes from the Furniture Reasons admin tab.

Mark Household Goods Unavailable

Household Goods uses unavailable quantities instead of the furniture Cancel Item button.

Step 1: Open the Household Goods voucher in the Cashier Station.

Step 2: Find the requested line.

Step 3: Enter the unavailable quantity.

Step 4: Choose the unavailable reason when the unavailable quantity is greater than zero.

Step 5: Use Save Progress if the voucher is not finished.

Step 6: Finalize only when all requested units are resolved.

- Fulfilled plus unavailable quantity cannot exceed the requested quantity.
- Once finalized, the voucher cannot be edited through the ordinary cashier workflow.

Common Questions

Q: What if a manager forgot their code? A: Regenerate the code from the Managers tab and give them the new code securely.

Q: Can I see an old manager code? A: No. Codes are shown only when created or regenerated.

Q: What happens if a manager is deactivated? A: Their code stops working. Their historical approvals remain in the records.

Q: Should I delete or archive catalog records? A: Archive them. Catalog records are connected to old vouchers, and old vouchers need to keep showing what was requested at the time.

Q: Where do emergency override reasons come from? A: They come from the Override Reasons tab.

Q: Where do furniture cancellation reasons come from? A: They come from the Furniture Reasons tab.

Q: Where do I review voucher edits? A: Use the Voucher Correction Audit tab.

Q: What if the Cashier Station asks for approval and the code fails? A: Check the manager name, code, and reason. After repeated failed attempts, the manager may be temporarily locked out.

Quick Reference Card

Use this as a station-side reminder after you have read the full guide.

ACTION	WHERE / WHAT TO DO
Add manager	Managers tab -> enter name -> optional 4-character code -> Add Manager -> save the code right away.
Regenerate code	Managers tab -> Regenerate Code -> save the new code. The old code stops working immediately.
Deactivate manager	Managers tab -> Deactivate. Their code no longer works.
Override reasons	Override Reasons tab -> add, edit, delete, or drag to reorder the dropdown.
Furniture catalog	Furniture Catalog tab -> manage categories and catalog items. Archive instead of deleting.
Household goods	Household Goods tab -> manage browse groups, categories, limits, and configuration audit.
Voucher edit	Cashier Station -> open voucher -> Correct Voucher -> enter changes -> manager name, code, and reason -> Submit Correction.
Emergency override	Cashier Station -> duplicate found -> manager enters name, code, reason -> Validate & Create.
Audit review	Voucher Correction Audit tab -> filter by voucher, neighbor, field, manager, actor, reason, or date.

Important Rules

- Manager codes are 4 characters using A-Z and 2-9.
- Codes are shown only when created or regenerated. Save them securely.
- Regenerating a code replaces the old code immediately.
- Archive catalog rows and cancellation reasons instead of deleting them, so old vouchers and reports still show what happened at the time.
- Use the audit log when you need to understand who changed what, when, and why.